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### Display device and audio output system

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#### Abstract

A display device including a display; a Bluetooth circuit; an Infrared (IR) circuit; and a controller configured to receive an IR signal including an IR keycode from an external speaker via the IR circuit, determine an identification of the external speaker based on the received IR keycode, control the Bluetooth circuit to begin searching for the external speaker, receive an advertising signal advertising a presence of the external speaker, the advertising signal including an identification of the external speaker, and Bluetooth pairing the display device and the external speaker through the Bluetooth circuit when the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal matches the determined identification of the external speaker.

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## Background/Summary

### CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application claims priority to Korean Patent Application No. 10-2022-0085121 filed on Jul. 11, 2022, in Korea, the entire contents of which is hereby expressly incorporated by reference into the present application.

### BACKGROUND OF THE DISCLOSURE

(2) Digital TV services using wired or wireless communication networks provide various services not provided in the analog broadcasting service. For example, Internet Protocol Television (IPTV) and smart TV services, which are types of digital TV services, provide bidirectional services allowing users to actively select the type and viewing times of TV shows. The IPTV and smart TV services also provide various additional services, such as Internet search services, home shopping services, and online game serves, based on the bidirectional characteristic.

(3) In addition, the TV can also transmit audio data output from the TV to an external speaker through a Bluetooth-connection. Accordingly, the user can enjoy a surround sound effect. However, according to the related art, the user must perform a complex procedure to Bluetooth-connect the TV to the external speaker.

### SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

(4) Accordingly, one object of the present disclosure is to provide a simplified connection procedure between a display device and an external speaker.

(5) Another object of the present disclosure is to connect a display device to an external speaker in response to a pressed button provided in the external speaker, one time, thereby providing the convenience of connection.

(6) According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, a display device may include a display, a Bluetooth circuit, an IR circuit to receive an Infrared (IR) keycode from an external speaker, and a controller to generate a random key set, as the IR keycode is received, display a key input window, which includes the generated random key set, on the display, receive an IR keycode set from the external speaker, and make a Bluetooth-connection with the external speaker through the Bluetooth circuit, when the received IR keycode set is matched to the random key set.

(7) According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, an audio output system may include an external speaker, and a display device. The external speaker may receive an input for selecting a first button, and transmit an IR code, which is previously set, to the display device, in response to the input received. The display device may generate a random key set, as the IR keycode is received, display a key input window including the generated random key set, receive an IR keycode set from the external speaker, and make a Bluetooth-connection with the external speaker through a Bluetooth circuit, when the received IR keycode set is matched to the random key set.

(8) As described above, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, a user can easily connect an external speaker to a display device through a single input to a button provided in the external speaker without a complex process. Accordingly, the convenience of connection is greatly improved. Also, when a plurality of display devices are provided, a user may easily Bluetooth-connect a desired display device to an external speaker by handling a button provided in the external speaker.

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# Description

## BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The present invention will become more fully understood from the detailed description given hereinbelow and the accompanying drawings, which are given by illustration only, and thus are not limitative of the present invention, and wherein:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram illustrating the configuration of a display device according to an embodiment of the present invention.
- (3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram of a remote control device according to an embodiment of the present invention.
- (4) FIG. 3 is an overview illustrating a remote control device according to an embodiment of the present invention.
- (5) FIG. 4 is an overview illustrating using a remote control device according to an embodiment of the present invention.
- (6) FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating an audio output system according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIGS. 6A to 6D are overviews illustrating a related art connection process between a display device and an external speaker.
- (8) FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating a method for operating an audio output system according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (9) FIG. 8 is an overview illustrating a process of Bluetooth-connecting an external speaker to a display device by a single button input according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (10) FIG. 9 is a flowchart illustrating a method for operating an audio output system according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (11) FIGS. 10A and 10B are overviews illustrating a process of Bluetooth-connecting any one of two display devices to an external speaker according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (12) FIG. 11 is an overview illustrating a process of Bluetooth-connecting an external speaker, when different types of display devices are present according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (13) FIG. 12 is an overview illustrating a process of Bluetooth-connecting any one of two display devices to an external speaker according to another embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (14) FIG. 13 is an overview illustrating a process of performing a Bluetooth-connection with a device having a connection history through different buttons provided in an external speaker according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

## DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

- (15) Hereinafter, embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the drawings. The suffixes “module” and “unit or portion” for components used in the following description are merely provided only for facilitation of preparing this specification, and thus they are not granted a specific meaning or function.
- (16) The display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure is, for example, an intelligent display device in which a computer support function is added to a broadcast reception function and is faithful to a broadcast reception function and has an Internet function added thereto, such as a handwritten input device, a touch screen Alternatively, a more user-friendly interface such as a spatial remote control may be provided. In addition, it is connected to the Internet and a computer with the support of a wired or wireless Internet function, so that functions such as e-mail, web browsing, banking, or games can also be performed. A standardized general-purpose OS may be used for these various functions.
- (17) Accordingly, in the display device described in the present disclosure, various user-friendly functions can be performed because various applications can be freely added or deleted, for

example, on a general-purpose OS kernel. More specifically, the display device may be, for example, a network TV, HBBTV, smart TV, LED TV, OLED TV, and the like, and may be applied to a smart phone in some cases.

(18) FIG. 1 is a block diagram showing a configuration of a display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. Referring to FIG. 1, a display device **100** includes a broadcast receiver **130**, an external device interface **135**, a memory **140**, a user input interface **150**, a controller **170**, a wireless communication interface **173**, a display **180**, a speaker **185**, and a power supply circuit **190**.

(19) As shown in FIG. 1, the broadcast receiving unit **130** includes a tuner **131**, a demodulator **132**, and a network interface **133**. In particular, the tuner **131** selects a specific broadcast channel according to a channel selection command. The tuner **131** can also receive a broadcast signal for the selected specific broadcast channel.

(20) The demodulator **132** separates the received broadcast signal into an image signal, an audio signal, and a data signal related to a broadcast program, and restore the separated image signal, audio signal, and data signal to a format capable of being output. Further, the external device interface **135** can receive an application or a list of applications in an external device adjacent thereto and transmit the same to the controller **170** or the memory **140**.

(21) The external device interface **135** also provides a connection path between the display device **100** and an external device. The external device interface **135** can receive one or more of images and audio output from an external device connected to the display device **100** in a wired or wireless manner and transmit the same to the controller **170**. The external device interface **135** may include a plurality of external input terminals corresponding to an RGB terminal, one or more High Definition Multimedia Interface (HDMI) terminals, and a component terminal, for example.

(22) The image signal of the external device input and the audio signal of the external device input through the external device interface **135** is output through the speaker **185**. The external device connectable to the external device interface **135** may be any one of a set-top box, a Blu-ray player, a DVD player, a game machine, a sound bar, a smartphone, a PC, a USB memory, and a home theater, but this is only an example.

(23) Further, the network interface **133** provides an interface for connecting the display device **100** to a wired/wireless network including an Internet network. The network interface **133** can transmit or receive data to or from other users or other electronic devices through a connected network or another network linked to the connected network.

(24) In addition, a part of content data stored in the display device **100** can be transmitted to a selected user among a selected user or a selected electronic device among other users or other electronic devices registered in advance in the display device **100**. Further, the network interface **133** can access a predetermined web page through the connected network or the other network linked to the connected network. That is, it is possible to access a predetermined web page through a network and transmit or receive data to or from a corresponding server.

(25) In addition, the network interface **133** can receive content or data provided by a content provider or a network operator. That is, the network interface **133** can receive content such as movies, advertisements, games, VOD, and broadcast signals and information related thereto provided from a content provider or a network provider through a network.

(26) In addition, the network interface **133** can receive update information and update files of firmware provided by the network operator, and transmit data to an Internet or content provider or a network operator. The network interface **133** can select and receive a desired application from among applications that are open to the public through a network.

(27) Further, the memory **140** stores programs for signal processing and control of the controller **170**, and can store images, audio, or data signals, which have been subjected to signal-processed. In addition, the memory **140** can perform a function for temporarily storing images, audio, or data signals input from an external device interface **135** or the network interface **133**, and store

information on a predetermined image through a channel storage function. The memory **140** can also store an application or a list of applications input from the external device interface **135** or the network interface **133**.

(28) The display device **100** can play back a content file (e.g., a moving image file, a still image file, a music file, a document file, an application file, or the like) stored in the memory **140** and provide the same to the user. The user input interface **150** can transmit a signal input by the user to the controller **170** or a signal from the controller **170** to the user. For example, the user input interface **150** can receive and process a control signal such as power on/off, channel selection, screen settings, and the like from the remote control device **200** in accordance with various communication methods, such as a Bluetooth communication method, a WB (Ultra Wideband) communication method, a ZigBee communication method, an RF (Radio Frequency) communication method, or an infrared (IR) communication method or can perform processing to transmit the control signal from the controller **170** to the remote control device **200**.

(29) In addition, the user input interface **150** can transmit a control signal input from a local key such as a power key, a channel key, a volume key, and a setting value to the controller **170**. Further, the image signal image-processed by the controller **170** can be input to the display **180** and displayed as an image corresponding to a corresponding image signal. Also, the image signal image-processed by the controller **170** can be input to an external output device through the external device interface **135**.

(30) The audio signal processed by the controller **170** can be output to the speaker **185**. Also, the audio signal processed by the controller **170** can be input to the external output device through the external device interface **135**. In addition, the controller **170** controls the overall operation of the display device **100**.

(31) In addition, the controller **170** can control the display device **100** by a user command input through the user input interface **150** or an internal program and connect to a network to download an application a list of applications or applications desired by the user to the display device **100**. The controller **170** can control the channel information or the like selected by the user to be output through the display **180** or the speaker **185** along with the processed image or audio signal.

(32) In addition, the controller **170** can output an image signal or an audio signal through the display **180** or the speaker **185**, according to a command for playing back an image of an external device through the user input interface **150**, the image signal or the audio signal being input from an external device, for example, a camera or a camcorder, through the external device interface **135**. Further, the controller **170** control the display **180** to display an image, for example, a broadcast image input through the tuner **131** or an external input image input through the external device interface **135**, an image input through the network interface unit or an image stored in the memory **140**. In this instance, an image being displayed on the display **180** may be a still image or a moving image and may be a 2D image or a 3D image.

(33) In addition, the controller **170** can play back content stored in the display device **100**, received broadcast content, or external input content input from the outside, and the content may have various forms such as a broadcast image, an external input image, an audio file, still images, accessed web screens, and document files.

(34) Further, the wireless communication interface **173** can communicate with an external device through wired or wireless communication. The wireless communication interface **173** can perform short range communication with an external device. For example, the wireless communication interface **173** can support short range communication using at least one of Bluetooth™, Radio Frequency Identification (RFID), Infrared Data Association (IrDA), Ultra Wideband (UWB), ZigBee, Near Field Communication (NFC), Wi-Fi (Wireless-Fidelity), Wi-Fi(Wireless-Fidelity), Wi-Fi Direct, and Wireless USB (Wireless Universal Serial Bus) technologies. The wireless communication interface **173** can also support wireless communication between the display device **100** and a wireless communication system, between the display device **100** and another display

device **100**, or between the display device **100** and a network in which the display device **100** (or an external server) is located through wireless area networks. The wireless area networks may be wireless personal area networks, for example.

(35) Here, the other display device **100** may be a wearable device (e.g., a smartwatch, smart glasses or a head mounted display (HMD), a mobile terminal such as a smart phone, which can exchange data (or interwork) with the display device **100** according to the present disclosure. The wireless communication interface **173** can also detect (or recognize) a wearable device capable of communication around the display device **100**.

(36) Furthermore, when the detected wearable device is an authenticated device to communicate with the display device **100** according to the present disclosure, the controller **170** can transmit at least a portion of data processed by the display device **100** to the wearable device through the wireless communication interface **173**. Therefore, a user of the wearable device can use data processed by the display device **100** through the wearable device.

(37) The display **180** can also convert image signals, data signals, and OSD signals processed by the controller **170**, or image signals or data signals received from the external device interface **135** into R, G, and B signals, and generate drive signals. Because the display device **100** shown in FIG. **1** is only an embodiment of the present disclosure, some of the illustrated components may be integrated, added, or omitted depending on the specification of the display device **100** that is actually implemented. That is, two or more components may be combined into one component, or one component may be divided into two or more components as needed. In addition, a function performed in each block is for describing an embodiment of the present disclosure, and its specific operation or device does not limit the scope of the present disclosure.

(38) According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, unlike the display device **100** shown in FIG. **1**, the display device **100** can receive an image through the network interface **133** or the external device interface **135** without a tuner **131** and a demodulator **132** and play back the same. For example, the display device **100** can be divided into an image processing device, such as a set-top box, for receiving broadcast signals or content according to various network services, and a content playback device that plays back content input from the image processing device.

(39) In this instance, an operation method of the display device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure will be described below may be implemented by not only the display device **100** as described with reference to FIG. **1** and but also one of an image processing device such as the separated set-top box and a content playback device including the display **180** the audio output unit **185**.

(40) Next, a remote control device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure will be described with reference to FIGS. **2** and **3**. In particular, FIG. **2** is a block diagram of a remote control device, and FIG. **3** illustrates an example remote control device **200** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(41) First, the remote control device **200** in FIG. **2** includes a fingerprint reader **210**, a wireless communication circuit **220**, a user input interface **230**, a sensor **240**, an output interface **250**, a power supply circuit **260**, a memory **270**, a controller **280**, and a microphone **290**. In more detail, the wireless communication circuit **220** can transmit and receive signals to and from any one of display devices according to embodiments of the present disclosure described above.

(42) As shown, the remote control device **200** includes an RF circuit **221** for transmitting and receiving signals to and from the display device **100** according to the RF communication standard, and an IR circuit **223** for transmitting and receiving signals to and from the display device **100** according to the IR communication standard. In addition, the remote control device **200** includes a Bluetooth circuit **225** for transmitting and receiving signals to and from the display device **100** according to the Bluetooth communication standard. In addition, the remote control device **200** includes an NFC circuit **227** for transmitting and receiving signals to and from the display device **100** according to the NFC (near field communication) communication standard, and a WLAN

circuit **229** for transmitting and receiving signals to and from the display device **100** according to the wireless LAN (WLAN) communication standard.

(43) In addition, the remote control device **200** can transmit a signal containing information on the movement of the remote control device **200** to the display device **100** through the wireless communication circuit **220**. The remote control device **200** can also receive a signal transmitted by the display device **100** through the RF circuit **221**, and transmit a command regarding power on/off, channel change, volume adjustment, or the like to the display device **100** through the IR circuit **223**.

(44) The user input interface **230** may include a keypad, a button, a touch pad, a touch screen, or the like. The user can thus input a command related to the display device **100** to the remote control device **200** by operating the user input interface **230**. When the user input interface **230** includes a hard key button, the user can input a command related to the display device **100** to the remote control device **200** through a push operation of the hard key button. Details will be described with reference to FIG. 3.

(45) Referring to FIG. 3, the remote control device **200** may include a plurality of buttons such as a fingerprint recognition button **212**, a power button **231**, a home button **232**, a live button **233**, an external input button **234**, a volume control button **235**, a voice recognition button **236**, a channel change button **237**, an OK button **238**, and a back-play button **239**. The fingerprint recognition button **212** recognizes a user's fingerprint and in one embodiment can enable a push operation, and thus receive a push operation and a fingerprint recognition operation. The power button **231** is used for turning on/off the power of the display device **100**.

(46) The home button **232** is used to move to the home screen of the display device **100**, and live button **233** is used for displaying a real-time broadcast program. Further, the external input button **234** is used for receiving an external input connected to the display device **100**, and the volume control button **235** is used for adjusting the level of the volume output by the display device **100**.

(47) In addition, the voice recognition button **236** is used for receiving a user's voice and recognizing the received voice, and the channel change button **237** is used for receiving a broadcast signal of a specific broadcast channel. The OK button **238** can be used for selecting a specific function, and the back-play button **239** can be used for returning to a previous screen.

(48) A description will be given referring again to FIG. 2. When the user input interface **230** includes a touch screen, the user can input a command related to the display device **100** to the remote control device **200** by touching a soft key of the touch screen. In addition, the user input interface **230** may include various types of user input mechanisms such as a scroll key or a jog key, and the present embodiment does not limit the scope of the present disclosure.

(49) Further, the sensor **240** may include a gyro sensor **241** or an acceleration sensor **243** for sensing information regarding the movement of the remote control device **200**. For example, the gyro sensor **241** can sense information about the operation of the remote control device **200** based on the x, y, and z axes, and the acceleration sensor **243** can sense information about the moving speed of the remote control device **200**. The remote control device **200** may further include a distance measuring sensor to sense the distance between the display device **100** and the display **180**.

(50) The output interface **250** can output an image or audio signal corresponding to the operation of the user input interface **230** or a signal transmitted from the display device **100**. The user can recognize whether the user input interface **230** is operated or whether the display device **100** is controlled through the output interface **250**. For example, the output interface **450** may include an LED **251** that emits light, a vibrator **253** that generates vibration, a speaker **255** that outputs sound, or a display **257** that outputs an image when the user input interface **230** is operated or a signal is transmitted and received to and from the display device **100** through the wireless communication unit **225**.

(51) In addition, the power supply circuit **260** supplies power to the remote control device **200** and

can stop the power supply when the remote control device **200** has not moved for a predetermined time to reduce power consumption. The power supply circuit **260** can also restart the power supply when a predetermined key provided in the remote control device **200** is operated.

(52) Further, the memory **270** can store various types of programs and application data used for control or operation of the remote control device **200**. When the remote control device **200** transmits and receives signals wirelessly through the display device **100** and the RF circuit **221**, the remote control device **200** and the display device **100** transmit and receive signals through a predetermined frequency band.

(53) In addition, the controller **280** of the remote control device **200** can store and refer to information on a frequency band capable of wirelessly transmitting and receiving signals to and from the display device **100** paired with the remote control device **200** in the memory **270**. The controller **280** can control all matters related to the control of the remote control device **200**. For example, the controller **280** can transmit a signal corresponding to a predetermined key operation of the user input interface **230** or a signal corresponding to the movement of the remote control device **200** sensed by the sensor **240** through the wireless communication unit **225**. Also, the microphone **290** of the remote control device **200** can obtain speech, and a plurality of microphones **290** may be provided.

(54) Next, FIG. **4** shows an example of using a remote control device according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. In particular, FIG. **4(a)** illustrates that a pointer **205** corresponding to the remote control device **200** is displayed on the display **180**. The user can move or rotate the remote control device **200** up, down, left, and right. The pointer **205** displayed on the display **180** of the display device **100** then corresponds to the movement of the remote control device **200**. As shown in the drawings, the pointer **205** is moved and displayed according to movement of the remote control device **200** in a 3D space, so the remote control device **200** can be called a space remote control device.

(55) FIG. **4(b)** illustrates that when the user moves the remote control device **200** to the left, the pointer **205** displayed on the display **180** of the display device **100** moves to the left correspondingly. Information on the movement of the remote control device **200** detected through a sensor of the remote control device **200** is transmitted to the display device **100**. The display device **100** can calculate the coordinates of the pointer **205** based on information on the movement of the remote control device **200**. The display device **100** can also display the pointer **205** to correspond to the calculated coordinates.

(56) FIG. **4(c)** illustrates a user moving the remote control device **200** away from the display **180** while pressing a specific button in the remote control device **200**. Accordingly, a selected area in the display **180** corresponding to the pointer **205** can be zoomed in and displayed enlarged. Conversely, when the user moves the remote control device **200** to be close to the display **180**, the selected area in the display **180** corresponding to the pointer **205** can be zoomed out and displayed reduced.

(57) On the other hand, when the remote control device **200** moves away from the display **180**, the selected area can be zoomed out, and when the remote control device **200** moves to be close to the display **180**, the selected area can be zoomed in. Also, when a specific button in the remote control device **200** is being pressed, recognition of up, down, left, or right movements may be excluded. That is, when the remote control device **200** moves away from or close to the display **180**, the up, down, left, or right movements are not recognized, and only the forward and backward movements are recognized. When a specific button in the remote control device **200** is not being pressed, only the pointer **205** moves according to the up, down, left, or right movements of the remote control device **200**.

(58) Further, the movement speed or the movement direction of the pointer **205** can correspond to the movement speed or the movement direction of the remote control device **200**. In the present specification, a pointer refers to an object displayed on the display **180** in response to an operation

of the remote control device **200**. Accordingly, objects of various shapes other than the arrow shape shown in the drawings are possible as the pointer **205**. For example, the object may be a dot, a cursor, a prompt, a thick outline, and the like. In addition, the pointer **205** can be displayed corresponding to any one point among points on a horizontal axis and a vertical axis on the display **180**, and also be displayed corresponding to a plurality of points such as a line and a surface.

(59) Next, FIG. 5 is a block diagram illustrating an audio output system **50** according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. As shown, the audio output system **50** includes a display device **100** and one or more external speakers **500-1** and **500-2**. The display device **100** can also establish a Bluetooth-connection to any of the external speakers.

(60) In particular, the display device **100** can perform a pairing and connection processes with respect to an external speaker. Thereafter, the display device **100** can transmit audio data to the external speaker, and the external speaker can output the audio based on the audio data. The display device **100** and the one or more external speakers **500-1** and **500-2** can thus output the audio to produce surround sound effects.

(61) Next, FIGS. 6A to 6D are overviews illustrating a related art connection process between a display device and an external speaker. Referring to FIG. 6A, the display device **100** displays a together-listening menu **610** in response to a selection input to a sound item on a menu.

(62) As shown, the together-listening menu **610** includes a surround mode item **611** which provides a surround sound effect through a Bluetooth device, such as the external speaker, and a speaker provided in the display device **100**. When the surround mode item **611** is selected, as shown in FIG. 6B, the display device **100** displays a speaker setting screen **620** showing whether to set one external speaker or two external speakers.

(63) When one external speaker is set, as shown in FIG. 6C, the display device **100** displays a device list **630** including registered devices and connectable devices. The user selects the external speaker to be connected through the device list **630**. Thereafter, audio tuning for the external speaker is performed through a tuning pop-up window **631**.

(64) Thereafter, as shown in FIG. 6D, the display device **100** displays a reproduction type selecting screen **640** including a surround effect item **641** and a speaker-simultaneously reproducing item **642**. The surround effect item **641** is for outputting a main audio through the speaker of the display device **100** and outputting an ambient audio through the external speaker to output a stereo audio.

(65) The speaker-simultaneously reproducing item **642** is for outputting the same sound through the display device speaker and the external speaker. The display device **100** can receive a command for selecting the surround effect item **641** to enter a surround mode. As described above, a complex process is required by the user to establish a Bluetooth-connection between the display device **100** and the external speaker.

(66) Next, FIG. 7 is a flowchart illustrating a method for operating an audio output system according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. In particular, FIG. 7 illustrates a Bluetooth-connection process between the display device **100** and one external speaker **500**. The external speaker **500** may include an IR circuit, a Bluetooth circuit, one or more physical buttons, an audio output module, and a processor, for example.

(67) Referring to FIG. 7, the external speaker **500** receives a button input for triggering a Bluetooth-connection to the display device **100** (S701). The external speaker **500** then acquires a preset IR keycode in response to the button input. In more detail, the preset IR keycode can be a specific code used for connection between the display device **100** and the external speaker **500** through Bluetooth communication. The external speaker **500** then transmits the acquired preset IR keycode to the display device **100** (S703).

(68) The value of the IR keycode may be '0x82', as an example. The external speaker **500** can also transmit the IR keycode to the display device **100** through IR communication and after transmitting the IR keycode, the external speaker **500** enters an advertising mode (S705).

(69) According to an embodiment, the advertising mode corresponds to transmitting an advertising

signal for notifying or advertising the presence of the external speaker to other devices. The advertising signal includes identification information of the external speaker **500** such as a Bluetooth medium access control (MAC) address and the name of the external speaker **500**.

(70) In addition, in response to receiving the IR keycode from the external speaker **500**, the controller **170** of the display device **100** switches a first sound mode to a second sound mode (**S707**). The second sound mode may include the surround mode and a simultaneously-output mode. In particular, the surround mode outputs the main audio through the speaker of the display device **100** and a sub-audio through the external speaker **500**.

(71) The sub-audio can be an ambient audio, such as background music, when a video is reproduced. In addition, the simultaneously-output mode corresponds to the speaker of the display device **100** and the external speaker **500** outputting the same audio. According to another embodiment, the controller **170** can set the sound mode to any one of the surround mode or the simultaneously-output mode, in response to receiving the IR keycode.

(72) After switching the sound mode, the controller **170** of the display device **100** searches for a Bluetooth device using previously stored device information (**S709**). The device information may include at least one of the MAC address of the Bluetooth device or the name of the Bluetooth device. According to an embodiment, the memory **140** of the display device **100** can store the IR keycode and an MAC address of a Bluetooth device corresponding to the IR keycode. The Bluetooth MAC address indicates information on a production place of the Bluetooth device, for example.

(73) The controller **170** can search for the device having the Bluetooth MAC address stored in the memory **140** using the Bluetooth circuit included in the wireless communication interface **173**. The controller **170** of the display device **100** determines whether a process (device search process) of searching for the device is completed, after searching for the device (**S711**).

(74) When the previously stored Bluetooth MAC address is matched to the MAC address included in the advertising signal, the controller **170** can determine the device search process as being completed. When the device search process is completed (Yes in **S711**), the controller **170** of the display device **100** can notify the device search process has completed to the external speaker **500**. Accordingly, the external speaker **500** terminates the advertising mode (**S713**).

(75) When the Bluetooth MAC address of the external speaker **500** is matched to the previously stored Bluetooth MAC address, the controller **170** can transmit a message for notifying address matching to the external speaker **500**. The external speaker **500** can terminate the advertising mode based on the received message. Thereafter, the external speaker **500** and the display device **100** perform Bluetooth pairing (**S715**).

(76) The Bluetooth pairing is a process in which the display device **100** registers the external speaker **500** for the Bluetooth-connection. In other words, the display device **100** can store the Bluetooth MAC address and a device name in the memory **140**. After the pairing is completed, the controller **170** of the display device **100** transmits the audio data to the external speaker **500** (**S717**), and the external speaker **500** outputs an audio based on the received audio data (**S719**). The controller **170** can transmit audio data corresponding to the sub-audio to the external speaker **500** through the Bluetooth circuit, depending on the surround mode.

(77) Next, FIG. **8** is an overview illustrating a process of Bluetooth-connecting an external speaker to a display device by a single button input according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. Referring to FIG. **8**, a user can select a first button **501** provided in the external speaker **500**.

(78) The external speaker **500** then transmits a preset IR keycode to the display device **100**, when the first button **501** is selected. The display device **100** then triggers a process of searching for a Bluetooth device, when receiving the IR keycode. In other words, the display device **100** searches for the Bluetooth device, when receiving the IR keycode.

(79) The display device **100** can display, on the display **180**, a device search pop-up window **810** showing that the device search process is in progress, in response to receiving the IR keycode

during the reproduction of a content image **800**. The display device **100** can determine whether the previously stored Bluetooth MAC address matches the MAC address included in the advertising signal received from the external speaker **500**, and determine the device search process is completed, when the two MAC addresses are matched.

(80) The display device **100** can perform the pairing for the external speaker **500**, and display, on the display **180**, a connection completion pop-up window **830** showing that the Bluetooth-connection to the external speaker **500** is completed. As described above, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the user can easily connect the display device **100** to the external speaker by a single input of the button provided in the external speaker without a complex process. Accordingly, the convenience of connection is greatly improved.

(81) Next, FIG. **9** is a flowchart illustrating a method for operating an audio output system according to another embodiment of the present disclosure. More specifically, FIG. **9** illustrates any one of a plurality of display devices **100-1** and **100-2** being Bluetooth-connected to the external speaker **500**.

(82) In FIG. **9**, each of the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** may include components shown in FIG. **1**. In addition, in the following description of the steps in FIG. **9**, the description of duplicative steps of FIG. **7** are omitted to avoid redundancy.

(83) As shown in FIG. **9**, the external speaker **500** acquires a first button input (**S901**) and transmits an IR keycode to the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** based on the acquired first button (**S903** and **S905**). The first button input is used for triggering a Bluetooth-connection with the display device by the external speaker **500**.

(84) In response to the selection of the first button, the external speaker **500** then transmits a preset IR keycode to each of the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** through the IR circuit. The controller **170** of the first display device **100-1** then generates a first random key set based on the received IR keycode (**S907**) and displays a first key input window including the generated first random key set on the display **180** (**S909**).

(85) When the received IR keycode is the same as the previously stored IR keycode, the controller **170** of the first display device **100-1** can determine that a trigger for Bluetooth-connection is recognized. The controller **170** of the first display device **100-1** then generates the first random key set, when receiving the IR keycode, and displays the first key input window including the first random key set on the display **180**.

(86) The first random key set may be the combination of four-digit keycodes. The value of each keycode may be either '0x83' or '0x84', for example. The controller **170** of the second display device **100-2** generates a second random key set based on the received IR keycode (**S911**) and displays a second key input window including the generated second random key set on the display **180** (**S913**).

(87) The controller **170** of the second display device **100-2** can generate the second random key set, when receiving the IR keycode, and display the second key input window including the second random key set on the display **180**. The second random key set may be the combination of four-digit keycodes. The value of each keycode may be either '0x83' or '0x84'. The first random key set and the second random key set may be different from each other to distinguish the display device **100** that the user wants to connect with the external speaker **500**.

(88) According to an embodiment, the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** can generate random key sets and display key input windows, when the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** are adjacent to each other in distance or position. Also, the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** can communicate with each other. In addition, the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** connected to the same router can be determined as the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** being adjacent to each other.

(89) In addition, the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** can share

connection information of the router with each other. The first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** having the same connection information can be determined as the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** being adjacent to each other. The connection information may include a service set identifier (SSID), for example.

(90) Further, the external speaker **500** acquires a second button input (**S915**) and transmits an IR keycode set corresponding to the acquired second button input to each of the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** (**S917** and **S919**). According to an embodiment, the second button input can correspond to sequentially selecting a plurality of buttons provided in the external speaker **500**.

(91) For example, the plurality of buttons may include a volume up button and a volume down button. The keycode value of the volume up button may be '0x83', and the keycode value of the volume down button may be '0x84'. The IR keycode set can be the combination of four-digit keycodes.

(92) After transmitting the IR keycode set, the external speaker **500** enters the advertising mode (**S921**). The controller **170** of the first display device **100-1** determines whether the generated first random key set is matched to the IR keycode set received from the external speaker **500** (**S923**). When the generated first random key set is matched to the IR keycode set received from the external speaker **500** (Yes in **S923**), the controller **170** searches for a device (**S925**).

(93) According to an embodiment, the controller **170** of the first display device **100-1** can compare the first random key set with the IR keycode set to determine whether the arrangements of values of each set are matched to each other. When the arrangements of values of each set match each other, the controller **170** of the first display device **100-1** can perform a search of the Bluetooth device.

(94) The controller **170** of the first display device **100-1** can compare a Bluetooth MAC address or a device name included in the advertising signal (or a search signal) with a Bluetooth MAC address or a device name previously stored in the memory **140**. When the first random key set is matched to the IR keycode set, the first display device **100-1** can set the sound mode to any one of the surround mode and the simultaneously-output mode. Thereafter, a device search process can be performed.

(95) The controller **170** of the first display device **100-1** determines whether the device search process is completed, when the device search process is performed (**S927**). When the device search process is completed (Yes in **S927**), the external speaker **500** terminates the advertising mode (**S928**), and the first display device **100-1** performs Bluetooth pairing for the external speaker **500** (**S929**).

(96) For example, when the Bluetooth MAC address included in the advertising signal (or search signal) is matched to the previously stored Bluetooth MAC address, the controller **170** of the first display device **100-1** can determine the device search process as being completed. After performing the Bluetooth pairing, the controller **170** of the first display device **100-1** transmits audio data to the external speaker **500** (**S931**), and the external speaker **500** outputs an audio based on the received audio data (**S933**).

(97) Further, the controller **170** of the second display device **100-2** determines whether the generated first random key set is matched the IR keycode set received from the external speaker **500** (**S935**). When the generated first random key set is mismatched from the IR keycode set received from the external speaker **500** (No in **S935**), the controller **170** displays a key value mismatch message on the display **180** (**S937**).

(98) FIGS. **10A** and **10B** are views showing a process of Bluetooth-connecting any one of two display devices to an external speaker according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. Referring to FIG. **10A**, the external speaker **500** transmits a preset IR keycode to each of the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** as the first button **501** is selected.

(99) The first display device **100-1** displays the first key input window **1020** on the display **180**, in

response to receiving the IR keycode during the display of the first image **1010**. The first display device **100-1** generates a first random key set (+, -, -, and +) when receiving the IR keycode and display a first key input window **1020** including the first random key set. The first display device **100-1** also displays a device search pop-up window **1021** showing that the device search process is in progress.

(100) In addition, the second display device **100-2** displays a second key input window **1040** on the display **180**, when receiving the IR keycode during the display of the second image **1030**. The second display device **100-2** also generates a second random key set (-, +, -, and +) when receiving the IR keycode and displays a second key input window **1040** including the second random key set. The second display device **100-2** also displays the device search pop-up window **1041** showing that the device search process is in progress.

(101) Referring to FIG. **10B**, the external speaker **500** may further include a second button **503** and a third button **505**. The second button **503** may be a volume up button, and the third button **505** may be a volume down button. A value of the keycode of '0x83' may correspond to the second button **503**, and a value of the keycode of '0x84' may correspond to the third button **505**.

(102) A user can determine a desired device, which is to be connected, of the first display device **100-1** and the second display device **100-2** by sequential selecting the second button **503** and the third button **505**. For example, the user can input the first random key set (+, -, -, and +) included in the first key input window **1020** through the second button **503** and the third button **505**.

(103) When the IR keycode set received from the external speaker **500** is the same as the first random key set, the first display device **100-1** can search for the external speaker **500**. The first display device **100-1** can complete the device search process, when the previously stored Bluetooth MAC address is matched to the MAC address included in the advertising signal received from the external speaker **500**.

(104) In addition, the first display device **100-1** can perform pairing for the external speaker **500** and display, on the display **180**, a connection completion pop-up window **1050** showing that the Bluetooth-connection to the external speaker **500** is completed. When the IR keycode set received from the external speaker **500** is mismatched from the second random key set, the second display device **100-2** can display, on the display **180**, a pop-up window **1070** showing that the keycode set is not matched.

(105) As described above, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, when a plurality of display devices are present, a user can easily perform a Bluetooth-connection to a desired display device by handling a button provided in an external speaker. Accordingly, the external speaker can be prevented from being connected to an undesired display device.

(106) Next, FIG. **11** is an overview illustrating a process of Bluetooth-connecting an external speaker when different types of display devices are present according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. **11** illustrates an example of a general-type display device **100** and a stand-type display device **1100**.

(107) When receiving a preset IR keycode once within two seconds, the general type display device **100** can search for the device. In other words, when receiving a preset keycode more than two times within two seconds, the general type display device **100** does not search for the device. When receiving the preset IR keycode once within two seconds, the general type display device **100** generates a random key set and determines whether the generated random key set is matched to the received IR keycode set. The general type display device **100** can search for the device, when the sets are the same as each other.

(108) When recognizing the preset IR keycode twice within two seconds, the stand-type display device **1100** can search for the device. In other words, when receiving the IR keycode only once within two seconds, the stand-type display device **100** does not search for the device. As described above, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, whether to perform the device search process is determined based on the number of times of receiving the IR keycode for a specific time,

with respect to different types of display devices.

(109) Next, FIG. 12 is an overview illustrating a process of Bluetooth-connecting any one of two display devices to an external speaker according to another embodiment of the present disclosure. Referring to FIG. 12, the external speaker 500 transmits a preset IR keycode to each of the first display device 100-1 and the second display device 100-2, as the first button 501 is selected.

(110) The first display device 100-1 can display a first pop-up window 1210 on the display 180, when receiving an IR keycode during the display of the first image 1010. The first pop-up window 1210 shows whether an attempt to connect the external speaker 500 is detected and a Bluetooth-connection is performed.

(111) In addition, the second display device 100-2 can display a second pop-up window 1230 on the display 180, when receiving the IR keycode during the display of the second image 1030. The second pop-up window 1230 also shows whether an attempt to connect the external speaker 500 is detected and a Bluetooth-connection is performed.

(112) The user can select a desired device, which is to be connected to the external speaker 500, by selecting a first OK button 1211 included in the first pop-up window 1210 and a second OK button 1231 included in the second pop-up window 1230. For example, when receiving a command for selecting the first OK button 1211 from the remote control device 200, the first display device 100-1 can search for the device. When the second display device 100-2 does not receive any command for the second pop-up window 1230 for ten seconds or more, the second display device 100-2 can output an audio through the intrinsic speaker thereof, instead of performing a device search process.

(113) Next, FIG. 13 is an overview illustrating a process of performing a Bluetooth-connection with a device having a connection history through different buttons provided in an external speaker according to an embodiment of the present disclosure. FIG. 13 illustrates each of the display device 100 and the mobile device 1300 having a Bluetooth-connection history with the external speaker 500. In other words, the external speaker 500 and the display device 100 have previously performed Bluetooth pairing, and the external speaker 500 and the mobile device 1300 have previously performed Bluetooth pairing.

(114) The external speaker 500 can transmit the IR keycode to the display device 100, when receiving an input for selecting the first button 501. Thereafter, the external speaker 500 can be Bluetooth-connected to the display device 100 according to an embodiment of FIG. 7. However, since the Bluetooth pairing has already been performed, a separate pairing process is omitted.

(115) In this state, the external speaker 500 can receive an input for selecting the fourth button 507 used for triggering the Bluetooth-connection to the mobile device 1300. The external speaker 500 can release the Bluetooth-connection to the display device 100 and transmit the IR keycode to the mobile device 1300, in response to an input of selecting the fourth button 507.

(116) In addition, the mobile device 1300 can search for a device, based on the received IR keycode and establish a Bluetooth-connection to the external speaker 500. As described above, according to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the user can freely switch a Bluetooth-connection to a desired device through one selection of buttons provided in the external speaker 500.

(117) According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, the above-described method may be implemented with codes readable by a processor on a medium in which a program is recorded. Examples of the medium readable by the processor include a ROM (Read Only Memory), a Random Access Memory (RAM), a CD-ROM, a magnetic tape, a floppy disk, an optical data storage device, and the like.

(118) The above-described display device is not limited to the configuration and method of the above-described embodiments, but the embodiments may be configured by selectively combining all or part of each embodiment such that various modifications can be made.

## Claims

1. A display device comprising: a display; a Bluetooth circuit; an Infrared (IR) circuit; and a controller configured to: receive an IR signal including an IR keycode from an external speaker via the IR circuit, determine an identification of the external speaker based on the received IR keycode, control the Bluetooth circuit to begin searching for the external speaker, receive an advertising signal advertising a presence of the external speaker, the advertising signal including the identification of the external speaker, and Bluetooth pairing the display device and the external speaker through the Bluetooth circuit when the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal matches the determined identification of the external speaker, wherein the controller is configured to: switch a first sound mode of the display device to a second sound mode of the display device, when the received IR keycode is matched to an IR keycode which is previously stored, and wherein the second sound mode includes one of a surround sound mode in which a main audio is output through a speaker of the display device and a sub-audio is output through the external speaker, and a simultaneously-output mode in which the speaker of the display device and the external speaker output the same audio.
2. The display device of claim 1, wherein the controller is configured to: determine the identification of the external speaker based on a stored external speaker identifications and corresponding IR keycodes.
3. The display device of claim 2, wherein the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal and the stored identification of the external speaker comprises Bluetooth medial access control (MAC) address.
4. The display device of claim 1, wherein the controller is configured to: transmit audio data to the external speaker through the Bluetooth circuit after the Bluetooth pairing is performed.
5. A non-transitory computer readable medium storing computer-executable instructions that when executed by a processor of a display device, cause the processor to perform the operations of: receiving an IR signal including an IR keycode from an external speaker via the IR circuit; determining an identification of the external speaker based on the received IR keycode; begin searching, via Bluetooth, for the external speaker; receiving an advertising signal advertising a presence of the external speaker, the advertising signal including the identification of the external speaker; and Bluetooth pairing the display device and the external speaker through the Bluetooth circuit when the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal matches the determined identification of the external speaker, wherein the IR signal is received from the external speaker in response to a button selected on the external speaker for triggering a Bluetooth-connection to the display device.
6. A display device comprising: a display; a Bluetooth circuit; an Infrared (IR) circuit; and a controller configured to: receive an IR signal including an IR keycode from an external speaker via the IR circuit, determine an identification of the external speaker based on the received IR keycode, control the Bluetooth circuit to begin searching for the external speaker, receive an advertising signal advertising a presence of the external speaker, the advertising signal including the identification of the external speaker, and Bluetooth pairing the display device and the external speaker through the Bluetooth circuit when the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal matches the determined identification of the external speaker, wherein the controller is configured to: generate a random key set based on the received IR signal including the IR keycode from the external speaker, display the generated random key set on the display, receive another IR signal from the external speaker including an IR code key set, and begin the search for the external speaker when the generated random key set matches the IR code key set.
7. The display device of claim 6, wherein the displayed random key set includes plus and minus symbols representing volume up and volume down buttons on the external speaker.

8. The display device of claim 7, wherein a number of plus and minus symbols is four.
9. A display device comprising: a display; a Bluetooth circuit; an Infrared (IR) circuit; and a controller configured to: receive an IR signal including an IR keycode from an external speaker via the IR circuit, determine an identification of the external speaker based on the received IR keycode, control the Bluetooth circuit to begin searching for the external speaker, receive an advertising signal advertising a presence of the external speaker, the advertising signal including the identification of the external speaker, and Bluetooth pairing the display device and the external speaker through the Bluetooth circuit when the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal matches the determined identification of the external speaker, wherein the IR signal is transmitted by the external speaker in response to a button selected on the external speaker for triggering a Bluetooth-connection to the display device.
10. A display device comprising: a display; a Bluetooth circuit; an Infrared (IR) circuit; and a controller configured to: receive an IR signal including an IR keycode from an external speaker via the IR circuit, determine an identification of the external speaker based on the received IR keycode, control the Bluetooth circuit to begin searching for the external speaker, receive an advertising signal advertising a presence of the external speaker, the advertising signal including the identification of the external speaker, and Bluetooth pairing the display device and the external speaker through the Bluetooth circuit when the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal matches the determined identification of the external speaker, wherein the controller is further configured to: control the Bluetooth circuit to transmit an advertising terminating message to the external speaker for notifying the external speaker the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal matches the stored identification of the external speaker such that the external speaker ceases transmitting the advertising signal.
11. An audio output system, comprising: at least one display device; and an external speaker, wherein the external speaker is configured to: receive an input of button included on the external speaker for triggering a Bluetooth connected with the at least one display device, transmit an IR signal including an IR keycode to the display device, wherein the IR keycode is generated based on the input of the button included on the external speaker, wherein the display device is configured to: determine an identification of the external speaker based on the received IR keycode, control the Bluetooth circuit to begin searching for the external speaker, receive an advertising signal from the external speaker advertising a presence of the external speaker, the advertising signal including the identification of the external speaker, and Bluetooth pairing the display device and the external speaker when the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal matches the determined identification of the external speaker.
12. The audio output system of claim 11, wherein the display device is configured to: determine the identification of the external speaker based on a stored external speaker identifications and corresponding IR keycodes.
13. The audio output system of claim 12, wherein the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal and the stored identification of the external speaker comprises Bluetooth medial access control (MAC) address.
14. The audio output system of claim 11, wherein the display device is configured to: transmit audio data to the external speaker after the Bluetooth pairing is performed.
15. The audio output system of claim 11, wherein the display device is configured to: switch a first sound mode of the display device to a second sound mode of the display device, when the received IR keycode is matched to an IR keycode which is previously stored, and wherein the second sound mode includes one of a surround sound mode in which a main audio is output through a speaker of the display device and a sub-audio is output through the external speaker, and a simultaneously-output mode in which the speaker of the display device and the external speaker output the same audio.
16. The audio output system of claim 11, wherein the display device is configured to: generate a

random key set based on the received IR signal including the IR keycode from the external speaker, display the generated random key set on the display, receive another IR signal from the external speaker including an IR code key set, and begin the search for the external speaker when the generated random key set matches the IR code key set.

17. The audio output system of claim 16, wherein the displayed random key set includes plus and minus symbols representing volume up and volume down buttons on the external speaker.

18. The audio output system of claim 17, wherein a number of plus and minus symbols is four.

19. The audio output system of claim 11, wherein the display device is further configured to: transmit an advertising terminating message to the external speaker for notifying the external speaker the identification of external speaker included in the advertising signal matches the stored identification of the external speaker, and wherein the external speaker ceases transmitting the advertising signal in response to receiving the advertising terminating message from the display device.

20. The audio output system of claim 11, wherein the at least one display device includes multiple display devices in communication with each other.

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